

BIS Certification Marks on Electronics and Electrical Products · Consumer C

TWO SCHEMES: ISI MARK AND CRS REGISTRATION

Electrical and electronic products reach the consumer under two BIS schemes. Under the Product Certification (ISI mark) scheme, a BIS officer audits the factory, samples are tested independently and the factory continues to be surveilled; products like cables, wires, plugs, sockets and switches carry the ISI mark with a CM/L licence number. Under the Registration Scheme (CRS), the manufacturer tests the product in a BIS-recognised laboratory, registers the product with BIS and declares conformity; electronics such as chargers, IT equipment, LED lamps and batteries carry a BIS registration mark with a registration number beginning with R-.

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COMMON ELECTRICAL PRODUCTS AND THEIR STANDARDS

PVC insulated cables and wires for household wiring are covered by IS 694. Plugs and socket-outlets up to 250 V are covered by IS 1293. Domestic switches are covered by IS 3854. Safety of household and similar electrical appliances follows IS 302. Safety of audio/video, information and communication technology equipment including chargers follows IS 62368-1. Self-ballasted LED lamps for general lighting follow IS 16102. Verify the exact standard applicable to a product on the official BIS source.

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WHAT THE CONSUMER SHOULD CHECK BEFORE BUYING

1. The ISI mark or the BIS CRS registration mark, as applicable to the product. 2. For ISI products, the CM/L licence number printed below the mark. 3. For CRS products, the R- registration number on the product or its label. 4. The rated voltage, current and power markings on the product. 5. That the mark is on the product itself, not only on the packaging. 6. Verify the licence or registration on the BIS website or BIS Care app. Avoid electrical products with no BIS marking: unmarked wires, plugs and chargers are a common cause of electrical accidents.

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MANDATORY VERSUS VOLUNTARY

Which electrical products require mandatory certification changes over time as the government notifies Quality Control Orders. Many household electrical items such as cables, plugs, sockets and switches have long been in mandatory scope, while certain appliances remain voluntary. Always check the current QCO list on the official BIS source before making a purchase decision.